

Creative Nomad and other portable players, became the new, must-have gadgets around the world.

The first players were only able to playback MP3 files and were not free of the occasional hiccups that made the pleasure of listening to music on the go, a sudden death wish. The players would hang playing music or playing back VBR encoded MP3 files that was a more common malady. Nevertheless, as with every new technology, each new generation brings in improvements and newer additions. Today, a MP3 player or Digital Audio Player (to be more politically correct) can playback MP3/WMA/OGG/ASF/AAC and other file formats. Even the most basic Digital Portable Audio Players available today can playback MP3 and WMA encoded files while the other file types are optional.



Talking about Digital Portable Audio Players, how can we miss the Apple iPod? One look at an iPod and anyone will be hooked on to it. The Apple iPod is more than responsible for making Digital Portable Audio Players a rage amongst the masses.

Newer players that do not sport the iPod tag are also available and their features sometimes far surpass those present on the iPod. However, the iPod still remains an icon when it comes to owning a Digital Portable Audio Player.

(Check out our comparison on the latest and the best available in Portable Digital Audio Players segment in this issue of *Digit*)